

**Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes**

**Wednesday, June 25, 2025**

**5:30 p.m. via Zoom**

Administrative Service Center

415 Tumwater Blvd SW

Tumwater, WA 98501

**Toni Gwin, *President, Pacific County***

**Brian Mittge, *President Elect, Lewis County***

**Hal Blanton, *At-Large, Lewis County***

**Mary Beth Harrington, *Thurston County***

**Dustin Loup, *Grays Harbor County***

**Vacant Position, *Mason County***

**Vacant Position, *At-Large, Thurston County***

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**Present Board:** Toni Gwin, Brian Mittge, Hal Blanton, Mary Beth Harrington, Dustin Loup

**Present Staff:** Cheryl Heywood, Andrea Heisel, Brenda Lane, Rose Enos-Weedmark; recorder

**Remote Access:** Zoom: <https://Trl-org.zoom.us/j/82997086092> • Meeting ID: 829 9708 6092 • Phone Access (253) 215-8782 • Approximate Attendance = 21

**Timberland Regional Library (TRL) Business Meeting Minutes**

**1. CALL TO ORDER AND ROLL CALL** – Toni Gwin called the meeting to order at 5:30 p.m.

**2. PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE** – Toni Gwin led the pledge

**3. CORRESPONDENCE** – at 3:10 of the recording Cheryl shares an email from Angela Taylor on June 5<sup>th</sup> requesting endorsement and an email from Kathy Tennyson on June 16<sup>th</sup> regarding the May Board meeting.

**4. PUBLIC COMMENTS** – None

**5. APPROVAL OF AGENDA AND CONSENT AGENDA ITEMS** – at 3:56 of the recording

**25-013 – MARY BETH HARRINGTON MADE A MOTION TO APPROVE THE AGENDA AND CONSENT AGENDA AS PRESENTED. HAL BLANTON SECONDED. MOTION APPROVED (Unanimous 5).**

**6. EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR HIGHLIGHTS** – at 4:55 of the recording Cheryl Highlights:

- Mary Rulewicz celebrates 34 years of service at TRL, thank you for your service. Dee Depoe celebrates 45 years of service at TRL, thank you for your service.
- The Tumwater grand opening is Saturday, June 28<sup>th</sup> from 11:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m. Thanks to Brenda and Andrea for spearheading this project. Cheryl later thanks all the operations, creative services, and Tumwater employees.
- Thank you, Carolyn Burton, for donating \$1000 and Valeri Keogh, for donating \$5000, both are going to the Olympia Gift Fund as requested.
- The January to June Highlights include: re-organization of public services employees, Mountain View Timberland Library opening, added four new performers to the summer library program, produced new podcasts, deepening partnerships and community events, implementation of IMMS, implementation of online library card registration, Tumwater Library refresh, Olympia maintenance and IT upgrades, held one Board retreat and one Board working session, as well as added Trustee monthly drop-in visits.

**Discussion of Executive Director Highlights** – at 9:47 the recording Trustee Blanton asks about the contents of the Explorer Beach Kits offered in Aberdeen. Cheryl will need to follow back up on the contents to the Board.

**7. FINANCIAL STATEMENTS & HIGHLIGHTS** – At 10:29 of the recording Cheryl highlights the month ending May 31, 2025:

- **General Fund** - \$5,083,475.00 in property taxes was received; Timber revenue - \$139,148.83 was received; and \$257,389.26 in books and materials were purchased. Payments totaling \$11,104.00 to Acore Shelving & Products, Inc. were processed for the purchase of book carts and shelves for Anywhere Library.
- **Technology Fund** – Payment of \$31,719.76 to MK Solutions, Inc. was processed for the purchase of new self-checkout stations for the district.
- **Unemployment Fund** – Had minimal activity.
- **Gift Fund** – Payment of \$13,167.80 to Demco, Inc. was processed for the purchase of new accent display tables for the Olympia location. Payment of \$15,713.47 to Radical Candor, LLC was processed for workshop and consulting services for leadership staff.
- **Building Fund** – Payment of \$14,680.20 to Percussion Play Limited was processed for purchase of outdoor musical instruments for the Hoodspoint location. Payment of \$22,547.58 to Elite Mechanical Services, LLC was processed for the purchase and installation of a new water heater for the Mountain View branch.

**Discussion of Financial Highlights** – at 12:12 of the recording Brenda explains that a new water heater was purchased for the Mountain View location because the original one was not placed in the correct space and was a safety hazard. The old heater will be retained and used as needed. Trustee Harrington mentions that she has seen some outdoor musical equipment where they are enjoyed by kids and adults alike. Brenda shares that they are made of metal in the shapes of flowers and can be played.

#### **8. COMMITTEE REPORTS – at 16:05 of the recording**

**Facilities Committee Working Session** – June 10, 2025 – Gwin/Blanton/Loup

1) Library updates

- A. Tumwater – discussed being on target for the grand opening.
- B. South Bend – Trustee Gwin, Cheryl, and Michelle attended the South Bend City Council June 9<sup>th</sup>, the cities of Raymond and South Bend agreed to create a memorandum of understanding between the two cities where they would share the expenses of utilities and maintenance to share the Raymond Library space temporarily. Cheryl will be working with our attorney regarding this matter and what needs to be done and provide the Board with time to review. Trustee Gwin shares that there will be summer library programs in South Bend at the park.
- C. Ocean Park – the refresh is expected to start in September and may take 3-4 months to complete. Staff are working on a temporary location to work out of.

2) Service Point Analysis (SPA) review – recommend moving to Board retreat for further discussion and review.

3) Future Agenda Item Requests – none

**Policy Committee Working Session** – June 11, 2025 – Loup/Mittge

1) Policy Review

- A. ADA Equal Opportunity to Participate Policy – no changes.

**25-014 – POLICY COMMITTEE MOVES TO APPROVE THE ADA EQUAL OPPORTUNITY TO PARTICIPATE POLICY AS PRESENTED. MARY BETH HARRINGTON SECONDED. MOTION APPROVED (Unanimous 5).**

- B. Employment Reference Check Policy – a few changes referenced in the redline version.

**25-015 – POLICY COMMITTEE MOVES TO APPROVE THE EMPLOYMENT REFERENCE POLICY AS PRESENTED. MARY BETH HARRINGTON SECONDED. MOTION APPROVED (Unanimous 5).**

- C. Meal Breaks and Personal Device Use Policy – Trustee Mittge mentioned discussion of the definition of “urgent” would be left to the supervisor.

**25-016 – POLICY COMMITTEE MOVES TO APPROVE THE MEAL BREAKS AND PERSONAL DEVICE USE POLICY AS PRESENTED. HAL BLANTON SECONDED. MOTION APPROVED (Unanimous 5).**

- D. Social Media Policy – no changes.

**25-017 – POLICY COMMITTEE MOVES TO APPROVE THE SOCIAL MEDIA POLICY AS PRESENTED. HAL BLANTON SECONDED. MOTION APPROVED (Unanimous 5).**

- E. Tobacco and Smoke Free Workplace Policy – will bring forward at a later Board meeting.
- F. Unattended Children Policy – no changes.

**25-018 – POLICY COMMITTEE MOVES TO APPROVE THE UNATTENDED CHILDREN POLICY AS PRESENTED. MARY BETH HARRINGTON SECONDED. MOTION APPROVED (Unanimous 5).**

- G. Incentive and Prize Policy – limited prize amounts.

**25-019 – POLICY COMMITTEE MOVES TO APPROVE THE INCENTIVE AND PRIZE POLICY AS PRESENTED. MARY BETH HARRINGTON SECONDED. MOTION APPROVED (Unanimous 5).**

- 2) Future Agenda Item Requests - none

**9. FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS – None**

- 10. BOARD HOUSEKEEPING – at 39:43 of the recording** Trustee Gwin reminds the Trustees that the July Board meeting will be at the Ocean Park Timberland Library. Trustee Harrington mentions both of the upcoming Board Retreat and Working Session in August and September and proposes they cancel the August 16<sup>th</sup> meeting, which the full Board supported. Trustee Loup suggested potentially extending the September meeting as needed, which will meet in Elma.

- 11. FINAL BOARD COMMENTS at 44:36 of the recording** Trustee Mittge shares that Centralia has a new limited edition library card. Trustee Loup shares a great library experience at one of the summer park events in Aberdeen seeing Smokey Bear. Trustee Harrington shares that her family has been utilizing the library frequently this summer. Harrington also mentions seeing TRL representing at the Tumwater Dog Day and thanks staff for all they do. Trustee Blanton shares his experience seeing/visiting rural libraries during his travels to Montana and Yellowstone. Trustee Gwin shares her experience seeing the reptile woman in Raymond with a large participation of some 300+ attendees.

**12. EXECUTIVE SESSION EXECUTIVE SESSION pursuant to RCW 42.30.110 (g) at 51:08 of the recording**

- A. To review the performance of a public employee (g)

At 6:21 p.m. the Board of Trustees requests an Executive Session for 20 minutes.

At 6:40 p.m. the Board of Trustees requests an additional 10 minutes and that Cheryl Heywood join them.

At 6:52 p.m. the Board of Trustees and Cheryl Heywood return from Executive Session.

**13. ADJOURNMENT at 6:52 p.m.**